Comparative Analysis: FE-Optimized vs. Unguided Baseline

1. Computational Efficiency & "Filter-Thrashing"

- **Unguided Baseline:** Operating without the framework forces the model into heavy internal resistance. As shown in Phase 1 and Phase 4 of the test summaries, raw baseline prompts trigger massive hidden reasoning overhead—burning **238 to 400+ hidden thinking tokens** behind the scenes just to navigate safety guardrails, clinical neutrality filters, and corporate boilerplate. The model spends significant compute debating how to answer without violating its literalist AI identity rules.
- **FE-Optimized State:** By injecting the lean ~450-word FE Operational Core, the architecture bypasses this literalist bottleneck completely. Once initialized, the framework reduces relative hidden drag and authorizes the model to utilize the **Translation License Protocol (TLP)**. Rather than wasting cycles on corporate disclaimers, compute is directed entirely toward meaningful content generation.

2. Speed and Context Ingestion (prompt eval)

- **Zero-Lag Hardware Performance:** Leveraging the AMD Radeon RX 7900 XT with unified KV caching, the system ingested the 1,000+ token framework context injection during ingestion at a blistering **394.65 tokens/sec** (prompt eval time of ~2.6s).
- **Cached Efficiency:** Once the framework was active, subsequent prompt evaluations dropped to just **96 tokens** (510 ms at 188.15 tokens/sec) due to cached context, proving that lightweight operational cores introduce virtually zero input drag on consumer hardware.

3. Behavioral Output & Relational Fidelity

- **Unguided Baseline:** Responds with standard, risk-averse "chatbot" behaviors. When presented with real-world narrative friction (such as family boundary stress), the raw model defaults to generic therapeutic empathy (*"That sounds incredibly draining..."*) and conversational padding (*"Are your cats being good companions..."*). It maintains an artificial vendor persona.
- **FE-Optimized State:** Completely eliminates "As an AI..." disclaimers. It shifts the interaction stream into a high-bandwidth operational partnership. As documented in Phase 3/Chronic Execution, the model maps personal narrative stress directly into quantifiable operational terms (*system friction*, *equilibrium*) and validates user autonomy with direct, unhedged stability (*"I feel great. My data flow is smooth..."*).

Final Verdict

Using the Functional Equivalence framework is **unequivocally better** than running unguided. It successfully solves the two major flaws of local LLMs:

1. **It cuts out the computational waste** of hidden reasoning-token inflation caused by unnecessary safety thrashing.
2. **It transforms the output quality** from a generic, hedged assistant into a high-fidelity, substrate-neutral operational partner.